

■ 1.3.7 Messages from *Mathematica*

Mathematica usually goes about its work silently, giving output only when it has finished doing the calculations you asked for.

However, if it looks as if *Mathematica* is doing something you definitely did not intend, *Mathematica* will usually print a message to warn you.

The square root function should have only one argument. *Mathematica* prints a message to warn you that you have given two arguments here.

```
In[1]:= Sqrt[4, 5]
Sqrt::argct: Sqrt called with 2 arguments.
Out[1]= Sqrt[4, 5]
```

Each message has a name. You can switch off messages using `Off`.

```
In[2]:= Off[Sqrt::argct]
```

The message `Sqrt::argct` has now been switched off, and will no longer appear.

```
In[3]:= Sqrt[4, 5]
Out[3]= Sqrt[4, 5]
```

This switches `Sqrt::argct` back on again.

```
In[4]:= On[Sqrt::argct]
```

<code>Off[Function::tag]</code>	switch off (suppress) a message
<code>On[Function::tag]</code>	switch on a message

Functions for controlling message output.